

cafg—6	cdeh—32	abfi—17	degh—8
cafgh—5	cdehi—7	abgh—3	deh—25
cafgi—24	cdg—3	af—19	dei—3
cafhi—3	cdh—7	afg—15	df—6
cafi—5	ce—10	afghi—9	dg—3
cag—4	cef—4	afgi—7	dh—19
caghi—6	ceg—3	afh—5	
cb—5	ceh—5	afhi—3	eg—5
cbd—4	cf—4	afi—14	egh—3
cbde—15	cg—5	ag—19	eh—11
cbdefghi—3	ch—3	agh—5	
cbdefhi—6		agi—3	gh—4

Please remember that I have not listed 138 further combinations that occur only once or twice. The amount of ‘mixture’ is bewildering. In spite of all that, for at least 80 years the following canard has been standard fare within the discipline: the Complutensian group is a composite based on the Koine and Andreas groups. But how does that idea square with the evidence given above? c occurs in no fewer than 129 combinations with other groups, quite apart from the times when it is alone. However, it is almost never entirely alone; a sprinkling of unrelated MSS will agree with it; but the roster of such MSS is always different (if the roster were the same, such MSS would be part of the family). The incredible range of unrelated associations permits two conclusions: 1) the MSS that represent the group can be identified and factored out, giving us an empirically defined family; 2) that empirically defined family **must be independent** of all other lines of transmission.

So what do pattern and dependency tell us about the evidence? They operate at two levels: within a group and between groups. Within a group they define the level of consistency or internal coherence exhibited by that group. Thus, among the nine groups in the Apocalypse, e, i and h exhibit the most internal confusion, which reduces their credibility as lines of transmission. a is large, but it has five subgroups; without the subgroups, it drops from 65 to 18—the five subgroups, plus further internal confusion, detract from its credibility as a line of transmission. In contrast to the rest,